Walking the coast, one mile at a time.

A practical guide to the twelve coastal routes of the northern shore, with maps, tide tables and the small details that make a long walk a good one.



148 km

of marked trails along the shore

12

routes, from easy loops to two-day hikes

CHAPTER 1

Before you set off

The northern shore is gentle most of the year, but the weather turns quickly in the afternoon. Start early, carry a light shell and plan your return before the tide comes back in. Most routes cross at least one beach that is only passable at low water.

Every trail in this guide is waymarked with a red post every five hundred metres. If you have walked twenty minutes without seeing one, turn back to the last post and look again: the path almost always bends inland at a stile or a gate.



Tide windows

Route	Distance	Low water crossing	Level
Harbour Loop	6.2 km	None	Easy
Gull Point	9.8 km	± 2 h	Moderate
Red Cliffs	14.5 km	± 1 h 30	Hard
Long Sands	11.0 km	± 3 h	Easy
Lighthouse Trail	18.3 km	± 2 h	Hard

CHAPTER 2

The Lighthouse Trail

The longest route in the guide follows the cliff tops for eighteen kilometres, from the old harbour to the lighthouse at Cape Wren. It is best walked from south to north, with the wind at your back and the light on the water in the afternoon.



The first third is easy going on a wide grassy path. After the second stile the trail narrows and climbs steeply to the headland, where a bench looks out over the bay. Take a break here: the next water point is at the lighthouse, two hours further on.

The descent to Wren Cove is steep and can be slippery after rain. Keep to the inland path if the sea is rough, and check the tide window before crossing the cove.